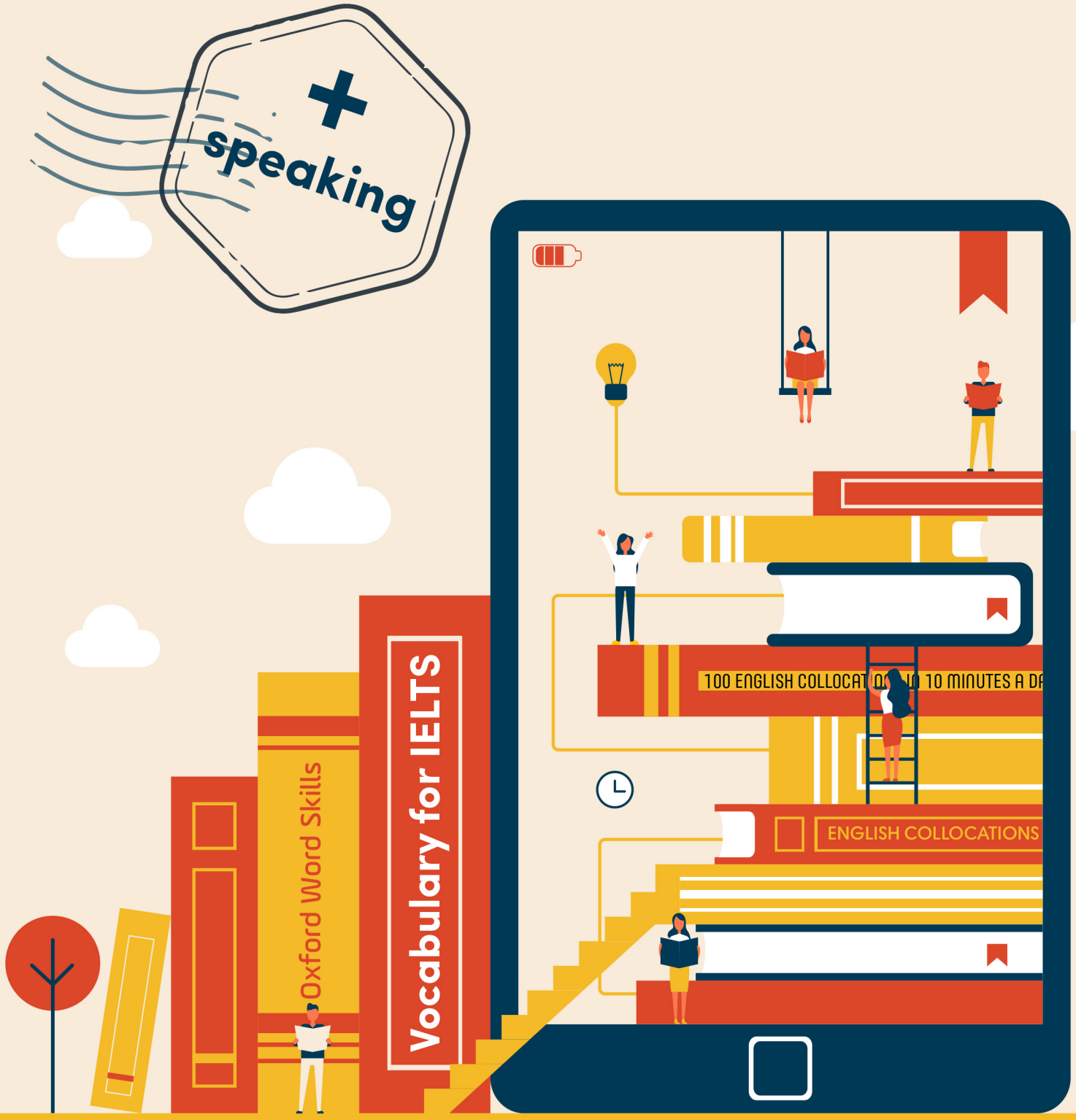
IELTS Up Words!

دوره لغات آیلتس

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Lesson 68: Depression

Hello! You are listening to another lesson of IELTS Up Words! This course is brought to you by Lingemy.com. If you have gotten this far, it means that you are enjoying this course, so make sure to check out our website for more educational content.

In the previous lessons, I talked about a couple of modern-day problems, such as obesity, traffic congestion, and consumerism. I also reminded you of the fact that there are many more problems in our society today. So, in this lesson, let's go through another issue that most of us have dealt with at least once—depression.

Depression is a mental problem that has only gotten worse. Work-related anxiety is one thing that has aggravated this problem. I consider it a current predicament and not just a minor issue that can be brushed off.

I am going to read a passage from "Vocabulary for IELTS Advanced," lesson fourteen, that is around the topic of depression. Listen to it and, if possible, jot down as many points as you can. Then, give a summary of what you learned, and share your own ideas on this subject as well.

"Depression is an ongoing and pervasive problem in our society, and it poses something of an evolutionary paradox: the brain plays a crucial role in our survival, so evolution should have left our brains resistant to such high rates of malfunction. The paradox could be resolved if depression was linked to growing old. After all, the functioning of all body systems and organs tends to deteriorate with age. This is not a satisfactory explanation for depression, however, as people are most likely to experience their first bout in adolescence. Perhaps depression is like obesity—a recent problem that has arisen because modern conditions are so different from those in which we evolved.

Yet this is not a satisfactory explanation either, as depression exists in every culture, including small-scale societies, where people are taught to live in environments similar to those that prevailed in our evolutionary past.

There is another possibility: depression is, in fact, an adaptation, a state of mind that can bring real benefits. This is not to say that depression is not a serious problem. Depressed people often have trouble performing everyday activities and tend to isolate themselves socially. So, what could be so useful about depression? Depressed people often think intensely about their problems. Numerous studies have shown that this thinking style is often highly analytical and can be very productive. Depressed people dwell on personal problems, breaking them down into smaller components. Each component is less problematic, so what begins as an insurmountable problem is far less difficult. This type of thinking allows people to gain insight into their problems. Indeed, when you are faced with a daunting problem, feeling depressed is often a useful response that may help you analyze and solve it. After all, depression is nature's way of telling you that you have got complex social problems that the mind is intent on solving. "

Speaking Tip

Top Apps

Evernote: Use this app/software as your second brain to categorize topic-related vocabulary and everything you learn.

OneNote: This app/software is similar to Evernote and can be used instead. If you have a tablet and a pen, this can be a preferred option.

Both of these apps can be synced across your devices, which is very convenient. They also have extensions for Google Chrome to help you save webpages and take screenshots of the content you want to keep.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
modern-day problems	problems that exist today/in recent times	مشکلات امروزی	contemporary issues/problems
a mental problem	a problem or condition that affects the mind	مشکل روانی	mental disorder; mental illness mental health
it should not be brushed off	it should not be treated as unimportant	نباید نادیده گرفته شود	dismissed
an ongoing and pervasive problem	a continuing problem that spreads throughout groups of people	یک مشکل مستمر و فراگیر	
an evolutionary paradox	A contradiction in the process of evolution	تناقض تکاملی	Evolution paradoxical
their first bout of depression	their first time suffering from depression; bout is defined as an attack of illness or strong emotion of a specified kind	اولین تجربهٔ افسردگی آن ها	attack; outbreak
they dwell on personal problems	they spend a lot of time thinking or talking about personal problems	آن‌ها مدت زیادی را صرف فکر یا صحبت‌کردن راجع به مشکلات شخصی می‌کنند	dwell upon on something
to gain insight into their problems	to get a deep understanding of their problems	درک‌کردن/دریافتن مشکلاتشان	to get a sense

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to aggravate this problem	to make this problem worse	تشدیدکردن این مشکل	opposite: mitigate
the current predicament	the unpleasant situation that is going on right now	معضل کنونی	dilemma; crisis
a minor issue	a small problem; something that is less important	یک مشکل جزئی	opposite: a major issue
to be resistant to something	to not want to accept something, especially changes or new ideas	در برابر چیزی مقاومت‌کردن	to be immune to something
high rates of brain malfunction	a high number of events where the brain fails to work normally	نرخ بالای عملکرد نادرست مغز	
a satisfactory explanation	acceptable details or reasons that someone gives to make something clear or easy to understand	یک توضیح قانع‌کننده	a sufficient explanation
small-scale societies	small and limited communities of people	جوامع کوچک	opposite: large-scale; major
to prevail	to prove to be superior in strength, power, or influence	مستولی‌شدن	prevailing
an analytical mind	a mind that examines things in detail, to discover more about them	یک ذهن تحلیلی	to be meticulous
an insurmountable problem	a problem that is too great to be overcome	یک مشکل حل‌نشدنی	formidable obstacles
a daunting problem	a seemingly difficult problem to deal with	یک مشکل طاقت‌فرسا	intimidating; unsettling
intent on solving	determined to solve	مصمم به حل‌کردن	resolved



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